

How to Use Gap Sense

A guide for people who will try the app.

This guide uses short sentences and simple words. It is written to be read with a screen reader, or read aloud to you.

1. What this app is for

When you cross a street with no traffic light, you need to know one thing:

Do I have enough time to cross before that car arrives?

To answer that, you must know how long *your own* crossing takes. Not in seconds. As a feeling.

This app helps you build that feeling.

The app never tells you a number of seconds. It plays sounds instead. You hear how early or how late you were. You feel the size of the gap.

That is the whole idea. Do not count. Listen and feel.

2. What you will hear

The app uses three sounds. Learn them first. It takes one minute.

Your tap sound. A plain tone. It plays back the moment you tapped.

The “good” sound. A short, high, bright chime. It means you were close enough.

The “not good” sound. A longer, low, buzzing sound. It means you were too far off.

The two feedback sounds are very different on purpose. One is short and high. One is long and low. You will not mix them up.

To hear them now: open **Help**, then press **Run the sound tutorial**. You can play each sound as many times as you like.

3. The most important thing

In practice, you will hear **two sounds close together**:

1. your tap, and
2. the correct time.

Listen to the space between them.

- A small space means you were close.
- A big space means you were far off.

That space is the lesson. It is not a number. It is a feeling of time.

4. Trying the app quickly

If someone gave you a link, open it. The app is ready to use straight away. It already has example times in it.

You can start pressing the button immediately.

Later, you can measure your own crossing. Then the app uses your real times.

5. The four parts of the app

The app has four parts. They are numbered 1 to 4 on the first screen. Do them in order.

Part 1. Measure my crossing

What it is for: to find out how long your crossing really takes.

What you do:

1. Stand at the edge of the street.
2. Press the big button when you step off.
3. Press it again when you reach the middle.
4. Press it again when you reach the other side.

5. Do this three times.

The app saves an average of your three walks.

Why three times? One walk can be too fast or too slow. Three walks give a better answer.

After each walk, the app plays your crossing time back to you as a sound. Listen to it. That is the length of time you need to learn.

Part 2. Practise my timing

What it is for: to learn the feeling of your crossing time.

What you do:

1. Press the big button. This means “I am stepping off now.”
2. Wait. Imagine yourself walking across.
3. Press the button again when you think you would have arrived.
4. Listen.

You will hear your two taps. Then you will hear the correct time.

Do not count seconds. Feel the time instead.

Do this many times. It becomes easier.

Part 3. Compare practice

What it is for: to learn to compare a car’s warning time with your crossing time.

“Warning time” means: the time from when you first hear a car, until it reaches you.

What you do:

1. Press **Play a gap**.
2. Listen to the sound. The length of that sound is the warning time.
3. Then choose one of three buttons:
 - **Shorter than my crossing**
 - **About the same**
 - **Longer than my crossing**

If you are right, you hear the good sound.

If you are wrong, the app plays both times for you, one after the other. First the gap. Then your crossing time. Now you can hear the difference.

Why this matters: if the warning time is shorter than your crossing time, you do not have enough time to cross.

You can do this part anywhere. You do not need a street.

Part 4. At the street

What it is for: to do the same thing with real cars.

Stay in a safe place. Do not step into the street.

What you do:

1. Choose the direction the car is coming from. Left or right.
2. Press the big button when you **first hear** a car.
3. Press it again when the car **passes you**.

The app tells you if that car gave you enough time or not.

If the car turns away, or never comes, press **Cancel**. Nothing is saved.

Before you start: press **Sample the quiet**. Stay still for three seconds. The app listens to how quiet the place is.

Why? If it is noisy, you hear cars later. So your answer is not reliable. The app will tell you when a measurement was taken in a noisy moment.

The app only listens to the noise level. It does not record any sound. Nothing is saved or sent.

6. Settings you may want

Open **Accessibility** from the top of the screen.

Sound, picture, or both. Choose what you want: - Audio only - Audio and visual - Visual only, with no sound

Vibration. Turn on **Vibrate on cue**. Then you feel the app as well as hear it. Press **Test haptic pulse** to try it.

Vibration works in the installed app. It does not work in the Safari browser on iPhone. Apple does not allow it there.

Text size. You can make text much bigger, up to three times.

Colours. Choose light, dark, or yellow-on-black. There is also a high-contrast setting.

Announce cues. This is for screen reader users. It is on by default.

The app goes quiet during playback on purpose. Your screen reader will not talk over the sounds. This is not a fault. The sounds are the lesson.

7. Useful advice

Never count. If you count, you are not learning the feeling. That is the whole point of this app.

Practise often, for a short time. Five minutes is better than one long hour.

Use headphones if it is noisy. But at a real street, do not cover your ears. You need to hear the traffic.

Your times change. If you are tired, or carrying bags, or the weather is bad, you walk slower. Measure again when things change.

Different streets are different. A wide street takes longer. Measure each street you use often.

8. If something does not work

I hear no sound. Check the volume. On iPhone, also check the small switch on the side of the phone.

I feel no vibration. Vibration only works in the installed app, not in the browser on iPhone. Also check that **Vibrate on cue** is turned on.

The app says “Times needed”. You have not set your crossing times yet. Press **Measure my crossing**, or ask your instructor to send you a setup link.

The buttons will not work. Steps 2, 3 and 4 stay locked until your crossing times are set. Do step 1 first.

9. Your privacy

Everything stays on your own phone.

- There is no account. You do not sign in.
- Nothing is sent anywhere.
- Your practice history is saved only on your phone.

If you want to send your results to your instructor, you must choose to do it. The app shows you the whole message first. Then you copy it yourself. It is never sent automatically.

You can delete everything at any time. Open **Progress**, then press **Delete all my practice history**.

10. Quick summary

1. Learn the three sounds.
2. Measure your crossing. Three walks.
3. Practise the feeling. Do not count.
4. Practise comparing gaps.
5. Try it with real cars, from a safe place.

Listen to the space between the sounds. That space is the answer.